

Approaches to Supporting Teamwork Solidarity: *Students' Self-Feedback*

- **CONCEPT:** Self-reflection is challenging!
- **GOALS:** Improve students' behavior by encouraging reflection and naming the specific behaviors we want them to demonstrate.
 - Help students understand desired behaviors
 - Have the desired behaviors at the top of their mind
 - Help each student to improve their behaviors
 - Help each student practice self-assessment
 - Help teams work together more effectively
- **APPROACHES** (*Each described further below*):
 1. Written Self-Reflection
 2. Behavioral Self-Reflection Checklist
- **IMPLEMENTATION WINDOW** (*When in the semester is this used?*): Multiple times during the semester, ask students to respond individually.
- **FACULTY EVALUATION CRITERIA SUGGESTED:**
 - Grade for completion. Make students redo it if they don't do a good job.
 - Use acceptable completion rubrics with descriptions that are clear, concise, and specific.

1. Written Self-Reflection

- **STUDENT PROMPT OR TASK:**
 - Ask students to respond to one or more of the following.
 - Have you followed the team contract/rules?
 - Have you asked for help? Have you offered help?
 - If not, were you communicative about it?
 - How do you see your contributions?
 - How do you think others see what you have contributed?
 - What went well this week/cycle?
 - What needs to be improved/changed/learned?
 - What have you done to contribute to the team/project this week/cycle? What was the effort needed?
 - Optionally, report back to the students what others think they have done and the effort they have put in.
- **FACULTY ROLE/EXPECTATIONS WITH DESCRIBED TASK:** Ensure that students understand the specific desired behaviors you want them to demonstrate. For instance, describing active listening and scaffolding why it is important for communication.
- **POTENTIAL CONCERNS AND APPROACHES:**
 - **PROBLEM #1:** If we have students discuss themselves or peers during an evaluation, students may interpret their peers' actions very differently based upon expectations from their cultural background. E.g., what people perceive as "fighting" can be very different.
 - **SOLUTIONS FOR #1:**

- Set aside time for discussion among the team around how they may interpret each other's contributions.
- Analyze case studies together using fictional and neutral scenarios of cultural misunderstandings.
- Describe how cultural values may have distinct interpretations, e.g., eye contact could mean honesty to some and could be disrespectful to others.
- Faculty could discuss emotional intelligence and what this could mean for cultural awareness, interpretation, the benefits of self-awareness and social awareness, and relationship management early on in the course.
- **PROBLEM #2:** Students might have AI write their reflections.
- **SOLUTIONS for #2:**
 - Have students write these reflections during class (maybe on paper).
 - Ask students to record a video of themselves where they talk through their responses.

2. Behavioral Self-Reflection Checklist

- **STUDENT PROMPT OR TASK:**

- Provide students with a list of 4-7 behaviors we want them to consistently apply. Each behavior would have lists of more specific things they can do to help them understand the desired behaviors. Aspects could include:
 - Technical/domain-specific competencies
 - Non-technical/transferrable competencies

Could then ask students to show where they have done/applied these behaviors, e.g., for openness, "I had this idea, and this other person then had a different idea, so I listened to them, and we decided to go with their idea instead." Along with this could pose:

 - What went well this week/cycle?
 - What needs to be improved/changed/made more clear?
- Another strategy is to have students pick their top 5 behaviors from a slightly larger set. This can help them have more ownership of it.

- **FACULTY ROLE/EXPECTATIONS WITH DESCRIBED TASK:**

- Ensure that students understand the specific desired behaviors that are being applied. For instance, describing psychological safety and normalizing making mistakes.
- Could ask students to submit some of their perceived behaviors and examples such that instructors could anonymize them and have the other students see how these behaviors may manifest.